

Chaithra Bekal

<https://chaithra28.github.io/>

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EDUCATION

- **George Mason University** Fairfax, VA
Master of Science in Computer Science (Concentration in Machine Learning); GPA: 3.73 Aug. 2022 – May. 2024
- **Visvesvaraya Technological University** Mysore, India
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering; GPA: 3.75 (8.47/10.0) Aug. 2016 – Aug. 2020

EXPERIENCE

- **Schar School of Policy and Government at George Mason University** Fairfax, VA
Data Analyst Intern Feb 2024 - Present
 - **Data Cleaning and Analysis:** Spearheaded data preparation including data collection and processing for the Mapping Shadow Influence project, elevating accuracy by 25%; Unearthed insights from government sources, bolstering decision-making. Improved Documentation and implemented better data collection methods.
 - **Python, Matplotlib and Network Analysis:** Leveraged Python, Pandas, Matplotlib to analyse the CSV files with data. Derived relationships and successfully communicated to supervisors of different academic disciplines.
- **iD Tech** Remote, US
Online Instructor in AI and ML May 2023 - Aug 2023
 - **AI, ML and Computer Vision:** Designed and executed more than 10 AI and ML lesson plans, guiding 20+ students to achieve a 98% success rate in completing Jetson Nano (Nvidia) projects for image processing.
 - **Mentoring:** Mentored and coached 15+ students in AI and ML projects, facilitating the creation of 7+ real-world applications using OpenAI's API for custom chat systems.
- **Intimetec** Bengaluru, India
Software Engineer Jan 2020 - Jun 2022
 - **Automation Testing:** Engineered an automation test framework from scratch using TestCafe, Mocha, and Typescript, optimizing both back-end and front-end testing. Crafted hundreds of automated test cases, slashing manual testing efforts by 40%.
 - **Selenium:** Added new testcases and fixed existing testcases in Selenium Framework of HP ITSM leading to 50% reduction in failures in Regression Testing.
 - **CI/CD and Jenkins:** Pioneered CI/CD implementation for automated testing and performance analysis, streamlining unit and system integration testing through Jenkins. Achieved a 200% increase in testing efficiency.
 - **Coaching and Interviewing:** Guided and coached 6 junior team members in testing methodologies and automation techniques. Conducted over 25 First Level Interviews for SDET positions.

PROJECTS

- **Sentiment Analysis of Baby Product Reviews:** Attained a 90% accuracy in sentiment analysis for product reviews using Logistic Regression with Python, Pandas, NumPy, NLTK, and Scikit-Learn.
- **Fake Covid Fact-Checked News:** Executed Exploratory Data Analysis on the Fake Covid Fact-Checked News Dataset. Delved into the sentiment analysis of news across diverse demographics using ML models (0.93 F1-score).
- **Fake Job Postings Detection:** Applied advanced machine learning models using Spark, including Logistic Regression, Linear SVC, Random Forest Classifier, and Multilayer Perceptron Classifier, resulting in a notable 87% accuracy with the Multilayer Perceptron in effectively identifying fake job postings.
- **Reproducing Results of EconBERTa:** Effectively loaded the ECON-IE dataset and performed preprocessing. Fine-tuning the model from scratch using EconBERTa from Hugging face to prove the claim stated by Authors. Achieved baseline accuracy of 67% as stated in the paper.

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

- **Languages and Libraries:** Python, SQL, Java, C#, PySpark, Typescript, Pandas, Numpy, Scikit-learn, PyTorch, Tensorflow
- **Technologies and Tools:** AWS, Kubernetes, Selenium, Jira, Jmeter, Git, VS Code, Jupyter Notebook
- **Machine Learning and Data Science:** Data Cleaning, Feature Engineering, Data Visualization, ML Algorithms, NLP, Neural Networks, Hyperparameter Tuning